

Paul Anthony Hirst

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<https://github.com/paulcarlile82-ctrl/rhcsa-proof-of-work>

Professional Profile

For the last seven months, I've been fully focused on teaching myself RHEL 9 and Rocky Linux from the ground up, preparing for my RHCSA certification. I'm not just reading about it; I've been running my own home lab on a couple of Dell Precision workstations, tinkering with storage, security, and containers to see how it all works in practice. Right now, I'm building out a self-hosted media server and getting into local AI setups, which I'm documenting on GitHub. I've run my own small SAS business in the past, so I'm used to the pressure of keeping things running, and I really enjoy the process of solving technical problems directly in the terminal. I'm looking for a role where I can bring that same hands-on, persistent approach to a team that values reliable systems and clear, honest documentation.

Technical Projects & Laboratory Experience

Self-Hosted Infrastructure Lab (2025–Present) I've spent the last seven months building a private lab from the ground up using two Dell Precision workstations. This has been my primary way of learning RHEL 9 and Rocky Linux, moving beyond theory into actual system management.

Regarding Zero-Trust Networking, I replaced traditional port-forwarding with a WireGuard/Tailscale tunnel to manage my lab remotely and securely. It's been a great exercise in understanding how to keep a network locked down without sacrificing access.

For Media & Storage Architecture, I am building out a Jellyfin media server, which gave me a chance to get comfortable with LVM for storage management. I physically modified the hardware by replacing the DVD drives with 1TB hard drives to maximize storage capacity.

In terms of Container Security, I've been experimenting with running applications in rootless Podman containers, focusing on SELinux policies to keep services isolated.

Finally, for Hardware Lifecycle & Maintenance, I handle all physical upkeep of my gear, including component upgrades, thermal management, and hardware troubleshooting.

Technical Skills

Core Linux: RHEL 9, Rocky Linux, Systemd service management, User/Group administration.

Infrastructure & Storage: LVM (Logical Volume Management), Filesystem management (XFS/ext4), Hardware troubleshooting.

Networking & Security: FirewallD, SELinux, Zero-Trust networking (WireGuard/Tailscale), SSH hardening.

Containers & Automation: Rootless Podman, Basic Bash scripting, Git/GitHub.

Documentation & Workflow: Markdown-based documentation, Terminal-first troubleshooting, SLA-aligned support mindset.

Certifications & Training

RHCSA (EX200) Candidate: Intensive preparation focused on RHEL 9 system administration (Exam Date: June 22, 2026).

Future Roadmap: Targeted preparation for RHCE (EX294) to master Ansible and Linux automation.